

Formulas That Tonify 补益剂

- Among the 8 strategies, this belongs to the tonifying (补法).
- Formulas in this chapter are used to treat – qi xu, blood xu, qi and blood xu, yin xu, and yang xu.
- Between qi and blood, yin and yang, tonifying one will have a salutary effect on the other.

- In “Discussion of the Spleen and Stomach” Li Dong Yuan said: “For blood xu, use ren shen to tonify, because when the yang qi is exuberant, it will generate yin blood”.
- In “Collected Treatises of Jing-Yue” Zhang Jing Yue said: “To tonify the yang well, you must search for yang within the yin... To tonify the yin well, you must search for yin within the yang.”
- Many formulas that tonify the yang(qi) therefore contain ingredients which tonify the yin(blood), and vice versa.
- For deficiency, tonify the mother is often applied as a strategy for tonification. E.g. tonify water to tonify wood.
- Side-effects will often develop when tonics are prescribed for individuals who are not suffering from xu – fever, HA, rash, pimples, insomnia, irritability, and digestive upset.

- Too deficient to be tonified 虚不受补 – the rich, cloying nature of tonifying herbs places a burden on the digestive system. It is usually necessary to add ingredients that promote digestion and assimilation. E.g. chen pi, sha ren.
- Mild, chronic conditions require a smaller dosage than do acute, life-threatening conditions.
- Tonifying formulas are generally cooked for a rather long period of time over a low flame (between 30'-1hr.), and are taken on an empty stomach to realize their full effect.

Formulas That Tonify the Qi 补气

- Formulas in this section are primarily used to treat Spleen and Lung Qi xu – generalized weakness, fatigue (with little exertion), a low voice/laconic speech, sob, profuse sweating; or prolapse, bleeding, and incontinence; a shiny pale complexion, reduced appetite, loose stools; a flabby tongue with white thin coating, a weak, or weak, large pulse.

- Treated with formulas that contain Qi tonics such as ren shen, dang shen, huang qi, bai zhu, gan cao, and some blood-tonics such as dang gui, as well as qi-movers such as chen pi, and damp-transformers such as fu ling, bai bian dou.

Si jun zi tang (four-gentleman decoction)

source: tai ping hui min he ji ju fang

- 四君子汤
- Ren shen 3-9 c
- Bai zhu 6-9 d
- Fu ling 6-9 a
- Zhi gan cao 3-6 e
- Actions: tonifies Qi, strengthens Spleen.
- Preparation and administration: grind the herbs into fine powder, take 6g as a draft. Or prepared as a decoction. 2-3 times of dang shen may sub for ren shen in mild cases.

Indications

- Classic presentation of Spleen Qi xu – pallid complexion, low and soft voice, reduced appetite, loose stools, and weakness in the limbs; a pale tongue with white coating, and a thin and/or frail pulse.

Analysis of formula si jun zi tang

Ren shen	Sweet, slt.bitter, slt.warm; Sp, Lu	Tonifies spleen Qi
Fu ling	Sweet, bland, neutral; Ht, Sp, Lu	leaches out damp, helps strengthen spleen,
Bai zhu	Bitter, sweet, warm; Sp, St	Strengthens spleen, dries damp
Zhi gan cao	Sweet, warm; Sp, Lu	Warms and regulates the middle

Applications: a basic Qi-tonifying formula.

- Peptic ulcer
- Atrophic gastritis
- Chronic active hepatitis
- Chronic ulcerative colitis
- PMS
- Uterine fibroid
- Recovering from infectious diseases in kids

Modifications

+ ban xia	With nausea, vomiting
+ zhi ke, chen pi	With fullness & stifling sensation in chest and diaphragm
+ suan zao ren	With palpitations, insomnia
+ fu zi	With kidney yang xu
+ huang qi	Severe Qi xu

Related Formulas

Based on si jun zi tang	New formulas	Indications
+ chen pi 6-9 (da zao, sheng jiang)	Yi gong san (xiao er yao zheng zhi jue) 异功散	Sp xu w/qi stagnation leading to an irregular appetite, stifling sensation
+ chen pi 3, ban xia 4.5 (sheng jiang, da zao)	Liu jun zi tang (yi xue zheng zhuan) 六君子汤	Sp xu w/phlegm & damp: loss of appetite, focal distention, a stifling sensation, nausea/vomiting
+ chen pi, ban xia, sha ren, mu xiang	Xiang sha liu jun zi tang (zhang shi yi tong) 香砂六君子汤	Sp/St xu w/qi and phlegm stagnation: belching, vomiting, diarrhea, abdominal pain/distention...

Related formulas (continued)

Ren shen, bai zhu, fu ling, zhi gan cao, cang zhu, jiang zhi hou po, chen pi, chao xiang fu, bai dou kou, mu xiang, sha ren, sheng jiang, da zao	Xiang sha yang wei tang 香砂养胃汤 (wan bing hui chun)	Sp and St xu with damp accumulation & qi stagnation
Ren shen, zhi gan cao, huang qi, rou gui	Bao yuan tang 保元汤 (jing yue quan shu)	Yuan(source) qi xu w/ coldness in children

Patent Form

- Si jun zi tang wan
- Xiang sha liu jun zi wan
- Xiang sha yang wei wan
- U.S.A.
- P. R. China & U.S.A.

Modern research

- Peptic ulcer prevention
- Anti-cancer effect
- Peristalsis-inhibiting
- Immune-stimulating
- Metabolism-promoting
- Hemopoiesis-promoting

Shen ling bai zhu san (ginseng, poria, and atractylodes macrocephala powder) source: tai ping hui min he ji ju fang

参苓白术散

- ren shen 1 kg c
- bai zhu 1 kg c
- fu ling 1 kg c
- zhi gan cao 1 kg c
- shan yao 1 kg d
- bai bian dou 750 d
- lian zi 500 d
- yi yi ren 500 d
- sha ren 500 a
- jie geng 500 e

- Actions: augments qi, strengthens spleen, leaches out damp, stops diarrhea.
- Preparation and administration: grind the herbs into powder, take in 6g doses with warm water. Decoction with 1/100 the dosage specified above.

Indications

- Spleen qi xu leading to internally-generated damp – loose stools or diarrhea, reduced appetite, weak extremities, weight loss, distention and a stifling sensation in the chest and epigastrium, pallid and wan complexion; or vomiting; a pale tongue with a white coating, and a thin, soft or deficient soft pulse.

Analysis of formula shen ling bai zhu san

Ren shen, bai zhu, fu ling, zhi gan cao – si jun zi tang	Tonify & strengthen Sp and St qi
Shan yao, lian zi – help ren shen	In tonifying qi to stop diarrhea
Bai bian dou, yi yi ren – help bai zhu, fu ling	In strengthening Sp and leaching out damp
Sha ren (acrid, warm; Sp, St)	Transforms damp, moves qi
Jie geng (bitter, acrid, neutral; Lu, St)	Unblocks Lu qi flow: ascending to treat diarrhea, disseminating to spread nourishment, as a Lu guide to prevent development of Lu xu

Applications: Sp qi xu with diarrhea (This is a well-balanced formula: warm w/o being dry, tonifying w/o cloying, leaching out w/o damaging normal qi)

- Diarrhea with the onset of menstrual flow
- Leukorrhea in relatively obese women
- Infantile malnutrition
- Allergic enteritis
- Chronic gastritis/bronchitis/hepatitis
- Mal-absorption

Applications (continued):

- Chronic nephritis
- Diabetes mellitus
- Liver cirrhosis
- Urinary tract stones
- Side-effects from chemo/radiotherapy
- Rickets
- Infantile anorexia
- Zinc deficiency in children

Modifications

+ gan jiang, rou gui	Diarrhea with cramps due to internal cold
+ huang lian, che qian zi, ze xie	Diarrhea due to damp-heat
+ shen qu, mai ya, shan zha	With poor digestion, anorexia
+ xiang fu, mu xiang	Diarrhea onset with menstrual flow

Related formulas

Based on shen ling bai zhu san	New formulas	Indications
+ chen pi	shen ling bai zhu san (yi fang ji jie)	Same as original formula with stronger moving middle qi effect
Si jun zi tang + huo xiang ye, mu xiang, ge gen	qi wei bai zhu san (xiao er yao zheng zhi jue) 七味白术散	Persistent diarrhea & vomiting due to chronic Sp St xu
+ huo xiang, ze xie, mai ya, chen pi, shan zha, huang lian, qian shi fen; - sha ren	(bao tai) zi sheng wan (xian xing zhai yi xue guang bi ji) 资生丸	1. Morning sickness or threatened miscarriage (1 st trimester) from Sp qi xu & qi stagnation; 2. Sp xu leading to weakness, reduced appetite, diarrhea, weight loss

Patent form

- Shen ling bai zhu wan
- Shen ling bai zhu pian
- Zi sheng wan
- Prosperous farmer
- Source Qi
- P.R. China
- U.S.A.
- P.R. China
- U.S.A.
- U.S.A.

Modern research

- GI tract-regulating
- Immune-support
- Circulation-improving

Review and Think

- Please compare si jun zi tang with shen ling bai zhu san
- Why can shen ling bai zhu san be used for chronic cough with copious sputum due to lung xu? Please deliberate from 5-E.

Bu zhong yi qi tang (tonify the middle and augment the qi decoction) **source:** pi wei lun

补中益气汤

- Huang qi 18 c
- Ren shen 9 d
- Bai zhu 9 d
- Zhi gan cao 6 d
- Dang gui 6 a
- Chen pi 6 a
- Sheng ma 6 e
- Chai hu 6 e

- Actions: tonifies the middle jiao qi, raises sunken yang.
- Preparation and administration: coarsely grind the herbs and take warm as a decoction by cooking two bowls of water down to one. Or prepare as a decoction. Or taken as pills with ginger soup.

Indications

- Sp & St qi xu leading to yang sinking – intermittent fever that worsens upon exertion, spontaneous sweating, a thirst for warm beverage, sob, laconic speech, a tendency to curl up, weak limbs, a shiny, pale complexion, loose and watery stools; a pale tongue with thin, white coating, and a flooding, deficient pulse, or a deficient, rootless pulse at the right Guan.

Analysis of formula bu zhong yi qi tang

Huang qi (sweet,slt.warm;Sp,Lu)	Tonifies raises the middle jiao yang qi to stop swaeting
Ren shen, bai zhu, zhi gan cao	Tonify spleen qi
Dang gui (sweet, acrid, bitter, warm; Lr, Ht, Sp)	Nourishes blood with huang qi
Chen pi (acrid, bitter, warm, aromatic; Sp, St, Lu)	Facilitates digestion of tonifying herbs and aids in raising qi by moving nature
Sheng ma, chai hu	Help raise sunken yang qi

Applications: Persistent Sp qi xu worsen with exertion leading to middle yang qi sinking – GI xu & general xu; prolapse of organs; chronic low-grade fever (unknown origin).

- Chronic and consumptive sx
- Prolapsed organs
- Recurrent miscarriage
- Leukorrhea
- Postpartum disorders (urinary incontinence, lochioschesis, insufficient lactation...)

Applications (continued):

- Leukopenia
- Pernicious anemia
- Chronic nephritis
- Chronic hepatitis
- Hypotension
- Hematuria from unknown reason
- Chronic colitis
- Chyluria (galacturia)

Modifications

+ bai shao	With abdominal pain
+ wu wei zi, mai dong	With cough
+ mu xiang, zhi ke	With qi stagnation
+ zhi ke, double huang qi	Severe qi sinking
+ bai shao, wu wei zi	Severe spontaneous sweating

Related formulas

ingredients	formulas	indications
ren shen, huang qi, zhi gan cao, bai zhu, sheng ma	Ju yuan jian 举元煎 (jing yue quan shu)	Severe blood loss and devastated yang due to qi xu leads to collapse
Huang qi, zhi mu, chai hu, jie geng, sheng ma	sheng xian tang 升降汤(yi xue zhong zhong can xi lu)	Sob, difficult & rapid breathing due to qi sinking in the chest
Huang qi, ban xia, ren sheng, zhi gan cao, du huo, fang feng, bai shao, qiang huo, chen pi, fu ling, chai hu, ze xie, bai zhu, huang lian, da zao, sheng jiang	Sheng yang yi wei tang 升阳益胃汤 (nei wai shang bian huo lun)	Aftermath of a damp-heat Sx leads to Sp St xu affecting Lu; Upper jiao sx affecting lower jiao leads to vaginal discharge

Patent form

- Bu zhong yi qi wan
- Arouse Vigor
- Ginseng and
Astragalus Formula
- Astra 8
- P.R. China
- U.S.A.
- U.S.A.
- U.S.A.

Modern research

- Gastric mucosa protection
- GI regulation (dual-direction)
- Immune support
- Cardiotonic
- Blood pressure raising
- Uterus stimulation
- Cancer/tumor prevention

Review and Think

- In bu zhong yi qi tang, why dang gui is included? Why chai hu and sheng ma included? Why huang qi included instead of Fu ling as in si jun zi tang and shen ling bai zhu san?
- Why bu zhong yi qi tang can be applied in bleeding disorders and leaking disorders?

Sheng mai san (Generate the pulse powder)

source: nei wai shang bian huo lun

生脉散

- Ren shen 9-15 c
- Mai dong 9-12 d
- Wu we zi 3-6 a
- Actions: augments qi, generates fluids, preserves yin, stops excessive sweating.

- Preparation and administration: xi yang shen may sub for ren shen.

Decoction, tid.

Indications

- Concurrent qi and yin xu – chronic cough with sparse sputum that is difficult to expectorate, sob, spontaneous sweating, a dry mouth and tongue; a pale, red tongue with a dry, thin coating, and a deficient, rapid or deficient, thin pulse.

Analysis of formula sheng mai san

Ren shen	Sweet, slt.bitter, slt.warm; Sp, Lu	tonifies yuan qi, generates fluids
Mai dong	Sweet, slt.bitter, slt.cold; Lu,St,H	Nourishes yin, moistens lungs, generates fluids
Wu wei zi	Sour,warm; Lu, K	Restrains lung qi leakage, generates fluids

Applications: concurrent qi and yin xu in upper and middle jiao with palpitations, a stifling sensation in the chest, sob, sweating, thirst, poor sleep, a pale red dry tongue, a slow-irregular/consistently-irregular pulse.

- Viral myocarditis
- Coronary heart disease
- Post-bypass disorder
- Arrhythmias
- Pulmonary heart disease

Applications(continued):

- Hypotension
- Iron-deficiency anemia
- Congestive heart failure
- Heart attack (myocardial infarction)
- Senile dementia
- infertility

Modifications

+ bai he, kuan dong hua	With cough
+ ma huang gen, fu xiao mai	Profuse sweating
+ shi hu, ge gen	Severe thirst

Related formulas

ingredients	formulas	indications
Fang feng ⁶ , huang qi ¹² , bai zhu ¹²	Yu ping feng san 玉屏风散	Defensive qi xu – pale face, hypersensitive to wind, spontaneous sweating, frequent sickness
Sha ren, mai dong, sheng di, wu wei zi, mu dan pi	Jia jian sheng mai san 加减生脉散	EPI in blood level with the exterior xu; Taiyin sx with smoldering summerheat
Ren shen, wu wei zi, mai dong, bai zhu, fu ling, zhi gan cao, sheng jiang, da zao	Ren shen wu wei zi tang 人参五味子汤	Chronic cough in kids leads to Sp xu: weakness, pale face and lips

Patent form

- Sheng mai oral liquid
- Sheng mai drip (iv)
- Sheng mai san wan
- Yu ping feng san
teapills
- P.R. China
- P.R. China
- U.S.A.
- U.S.A.

Modern research

- Cardiotonic
- Coronary-blood-flow reinforcing
- Maximize oxygen usage for myocardium
- Microcirculation improving
- Anti-shock
- Blood pressure regulation (dual-direction)

Ren shen ge jie san (ginseng and gecko powder)

source: wei sheng bao jian

人參蛤蚧散

- Ge jie 1 pair c
- Ren shen 60 d
- Fu ling 60 d
- Sang bai pi 60 d
- Xing ren 150 d
- Chuan bei mu 60 a
- Zhi mu 60 a
- Zhi gan cao 150 e

- Actions: tonifies qi, clears heat, transforms phlegm, stops coughing, and arrests wheezing.
- Preparation and administration: grind the ingredients into a fine powder, taken in 6g doses with warm water, bid, on an empty stomach.

Indications

- Lung qi xu with heat in lungs – chronic coughing and wheezing, thick, yellow sputum, coughing of pus and blood, a sensation of heat and irritability in the chest, facial edema, gradual emaciation; a purple tongue with either a thin and white or a greasy, thin, and yellow tongue coating, and a floating, deficient pulse, especially at the distal position (Cun).

Analysis of formula ren shen ge jie san

Ge jie	Salty, neutral; Lu, K	Tonifies Lu & K, arrests wheezing
Ren shen	Sweet, slt.bitter, slt.warm; Sp, Lu	Tonifies yuan qi and lung/spleen
Fu ling	Sweet, bland, neutral; Ht, Sp, Lu	Benefits Sp by draining damp
Sang bai pi, xing ren	A herb pair to treat Lung heat due to constraint	Regulate Lu qi and direct rebellious qi downward
Chuan bei mu, zhi mu	A herb pair to Lung yin xu heat	Clear xu heat, nourish yin, transform damp to stop coughing
Zhi gan cao	envoy	Harmonizes; tonifies qi

Applications: Lu & K xu with phlegm-heat due to long-term coughing/wheezing

- Chronic bronchitis
- Bronchial asthma
- Emphysema
- Pulmonary tuberculosis

Modifications

- sang bai pi, zhi mu	Without heat
+ mai dong	Severe yin xu
+ bai mao gen, di yu tan, ce bai tan	Coughing of pus and blood or blood-streaked sputum

Related formula

ingredients	formula	indication
Ren shen 6-9 hu tao ren 5 nuts Sheng jiang 5 pieces	Ren shen hu tao tang 人参胡桃汤 (ji sheng fang)	Both K & Lu – coughing, wheez ing, chest fullness, inability to lie supine.

Review and Think

- 1. Compare ren shen hu tao tang with ren shen ge jie san.**
- 2. Compare ren shen hu tao tang with shen mai san.**
- 3. List the indications of bu zhong yi qi tang.**
- 4. Analyze shen ling bai zhu san with a focus on the relationships among the ingredients.**